conviction: value is not always inherent in the material itself; it can be created through imagination, craftsmanship and responsible reinvention.

This cultural engagement found an early expression in ***Nayaab,*** an initiative pioneered by M3M Foundation in 2024. Rooted in the recognition of India's extraordinary artistic talent and traditional knowledge, Nayaab sought to bring greater attention to the relationship between creativity, cultural preservation and livelihoods.

Its underlying philosophy was significant: traditions cannot survive on admiration alone. They require patronage, visibility, market opportunities and a new generation that sees a viable future in carrying them forward. Nayaab helped establish the foundation for a larger vision—one in which the preservation of art and craft becomes an instrument of empowerment and enterprise.

In 2026, this vision evolved through ***Threads of India – Bharat Ka Taana Baana,*** an initiative connecting India's textile heritage with contemporary fashion and women's economic empowerment. The Foundation's team travelled to traditional craft clusters, engaging directly with weavers and artisans to understand the techniques, materials and cultural narratives behind their work. Young women from M3M Foundation's iMpower Academy for Skills were then connected with these traditional masters, creating a dialogue between inherited knowledge and contemporary design.

The journey culminated in ***Ada-e-Hind,*** a collection of 32 distinctive garments created by four young women artisans. Drawing inspiration from traditions including Banarasi weaving, Chikankari, Bandhani, Patola, Ajrakh, Phulkari, Paithani and Kanjivaram, the collection interpreted India's textile vocabulary through contemporary silhouettes. Its presentation at Times Lifestyle Fashion Week gave these emerging creators a platform within the country's fashion landscape.

Yet, for Dr. Kanodia, the runway was only the beginning. The larger ambition was



to ensure that recognition translated into opportunity. At an exclusive ***Evening of Patronage & Purpose,*** the garments were presented through an auction designed to generate support for the initiative's next phase. The vision is to build a dedicated pool of resources that can help more young women establish self-sustaining boutique businesses, supported by training in design, costing, branding, marketing, digital commerce, equipment and mentorship. The aspiration is not merely to train women in garment-making, but to enable them to become designers, business owners and employers. It is a transition from acquiring a skill to owning an enterprise—and from economic participation to economic independence.

The global luxury industry offers an important lesson: craftsmanship acquires enduring commercial value when supported by strong institutions, distinctive narratives, quality standards and access to discerning markets. India possesses the cultural depth and artisanal expertise to build such an ecosystem, provided its creators are recognised as custodians of valuable intellectual and creative capital. M3M Foundation's initiatives seek to bridge precisely this divide. They challenge the notion that luxury must be imported, distant or inaccessible. An exquisitely crafted Indian textile, a restored historic structure or a sculpture fashioned from reclaimed material can embody a form of distinction that is both culturally authentic and environmentally conscious. For Dr. Kanodia, this is the larger purpose of philanthropy: not simply to preserve what exists, but to create the conditions for it to flourish anew. By connecting heritage with contemporary markets and craftsmanship with entrepreneurship, M3M Foundation is working towards a model in which communities share in the value of the traditions they sustain.

The next chapter of Indian luxury need not be written by borrowing the vocabulary of the West. It can be authored through India's own extraordinary heritage—where beauty carries provenance, craftsmanship commands recognition, and prosperity reaches the very hands that create it.